

Summary Post

by Séba Daher - Friday, 15 May 2026, 5:32 AM

(Evidence: <https://www.my-course.co.uk/mod/forum/discuss.php?d=366344#p737886>)

The three-week discussion, anchored in Hancock et al. (2024), has traced a progression from identifying discrete failure modes to establishing the methodological conditions required to address them systematically. The initial post foregrounded geographical bias in Automatic Identification System data, the suppression of risk as a two-dimensional quantity (Hubbard, 2020), and the design-phase exclusion of affected communities as compounding sources of unfairness. Peer contributions from Peer A and Peer B usefully extended this analysis, introducing data triangulation, explainable AI, Human Rights Impact Assessments, and participatory governance frameworks as concrete mitigation strategies. Sanders and Stappers (2008) and Costanza-Chock (2020) provided a principled basis for treating community involvement not as optional consultation but as a structural requirement.

Subsequent responses introduced two dimensions the discussion had not initially foregrounded. First, digital data collection creates a distinct physical risk: if records of victims, witnesses, or informants are compromised, exposure to retaliation by the very actors under investigation becomes plausible. Renn et al. (2021) note that digital infrastructure serves as a tool of control as readily as accountability, which makes adversary-aware system design a prerequisite, not an afterthought. Second, the legal defensibility of algorithmically derived evidence depends on investigators retaining the technical literacy to interrogate outputs critically. Where workflows are structured around accepting automated classifications as authoritative, human oversight becomes nominal, and accountability cannot be meaningfully assigned (AIRMIC, 2010; Dubberley et al., 2020).

Unit 3 supplies the methodological bridge. The structured threat modelling techniques reviewed by Shevchenko et al. (2018), including STRIDE for classifying threat types and PASTA for integrating business impact, provide a reproducible vocabulary for surfacing precisely the adversarial scenarios that informal risk language tends to obscure. Applied prospectively, at the design stage, these frameworks operationalise the precautionary reasoning that Aven and Thekdi (2025) prescribe for novel, uncertainty-laden environments. The discussion as a whole demonstrates that fairness in human rights technology is not a post-deployment audit concern but a risk engineering problem requiring structured analysis before systems are built.

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